06 | CLEAR REQUESTS | RESOURCE

How to Make a Clear Request

Six steps for asking someone else to decide while you keep working on your part

01	**Name the exact decision** Be specific. “Which coverage option is approved?” is clearer than “Please handle this problem.” Say what answer, approval, or clarification you need.
02	**Check authority and boundaries** Review the current role guidance, your branch RACI, and the Decision & Permission Matrix. Separate the work you own from decisions that belong to someone else.
03	**Gather facts and required input** Use current sources and confirmed facts. Say what information is missing. Get any required input, and don’t present an assumption as a fact.
04	**Offer options and a recommendation** Give two realistic options when you can. Explain the effect on services and resources, and the trade-offs. If only one option works, explain why.
05	**Use the correct route and verify timing** Confirm who decides, when the decision is needed, when to expect a reply, and when the next update will come. A date you asked for is not the same as a date someone agreed to.
06	**Track the reply and close the loop** Before you send the request, decide who will follow up. After you send it, record the answer, confirm the next step and who owns it, and update the people affected.

Getting a reply vs. solving the issue

The two-working-day standard means you will get an answer or the name of the person handling your question. It does not promise the issue will be solved in that time. If more time is needed, confirm when the next update will come. Urgent issues go through the required process right away.

Source: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.

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Clear Request Worksheet and Examples

Use real facts, approved sources, and confirmed dates.

Step	Your request
Decision needed	
Authority and source	
Facts and input needed	
Options and recommendation	
Who decides, and when	
Who tracks it, and next step	

Sample request

Asking for a decision on coverage

"We need a decision on one of two coverage options. The attached summary shows the gap, both options, and the input we received. I recommend option A because it keeps the service window covered. We need a decision before the window starts. Please let me know who will decide and when we can expect an answer or update. I will track the reply and let the team know."

Made-up example.

Following up on an unanswered request

> *"I'm following up on my request from _____. We agreed on an update by _____. The open decision is _____. New information: _____. If this waits, _____. Please send the answer, the name of the person handling it, or a date for the next update."*

After you get an answer

Write down the decision and any limits. Confirm who will do what, and by when. Share the update with the people affected. While you wait for approval, only do work you already have authority to do.

Source: Decision & Escalation training, six-step request checklist; Communicating CLEAR training, slide 41.